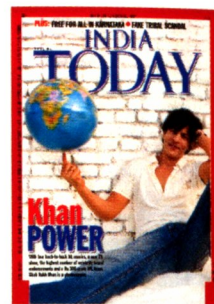


BANDEEP SINGH



"Khan Power",
May 12, 2008

"What is good about Shah Rukh Khan is that despite his success, he remains a devoted husband and father and a loyal friend."

RANJANA MANCHANDA, on e-mail

Khan Express

History will not judge Shah Rukh Khan by his riches but what he has given to the nation ("Khan Market", May 12). I find a contradiction in his dancing at parties and at the same time doing a nationalist film like *Chak De! India*.
R.D. SINGH, *Leh*

The cover story was a refreshing change from the usual topics. However, I would like to request Khan to spend at least 2 per cent of his earnings on philanthropic work.
BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE, *Faridabad*

Khan is everywhere today but it is too much to be taken together. He has reached the top and achieved everything that can be achieved. It is time he heeded his well-wishers' advice and slowed down.
A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Your choice of Khan as the cover bemused me. By foraying into many areas he has, no doubt, amassed immense wealth and popularity but not much respect and awe in terms of his creative contribution to any of them including his core competency—acting. He is more in the company of the earlier Jubilee Kumars than legends like Dev Anand and Dilip Kumar.
Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

The kind of publicity that is being showered upon Khan makes one feel as if no one else is important today. Though a talented actor, he is no more the handsome man he once was. He should now leave those "hero" roles for the younger generation.
A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

This one-sided, all dimples and no wart story on Khan is just another media-sponsored coup by the actor. He is a living example of how

the system can be manipulated to your singular advantage, like getting a paid crowd to stand outside your home and then calling in the media.

ASHEESH BHAT, *Mumbai*

It's a Poor Commission

The Sixth Pay Commission seeks to reward the Indian Administrative Service—one of the most inefficient services in the world—even as it shamelessly demoralises the Indian armed forces, which is one of the most competent organisations in the world. ("It Pays to be a Babu", May 12).

KARAN KHARB, *Noida*

This pay commission has been constituted only to establish the supremacy of the babus. Politicians will not listen to the grievances of the defence personnel as they do not constitute a votebank. God and the soldier are remembered only during emergency.
SHRI KRISHAN, *Gurgaon*

Considering their yeoman's service to the nation, the salaries of the defence personnel should be made tax-free.

MAHESH KAPASI, *Delhi*

The pay and allowances of the armed forces must be in consonance with their work and the conditions which they work in, among other factors. The system must be designed to attract suitable young talent, which will fill in the needs of the forces.

R. DEVASAR, *Noida*

Silent Spectator

It is disheartening to note that the prime minister has failed to take any action against Shipping Minister T.R. Baalu for misusing his office ("Slipping on an Oil Slick", May 12). Though a coalition, it is not expected that a prime minister of impeccable credentials will be weak in dealing with unethical behaviour.
RAMESH AGARWAL, *Kanpur*